

This week's dinners, for 2 people

SUNDAY

Oven Chicken and Veggie Kebab Plates 35 min

YOU WILL NEED

0.75 lb boneless chicken thighs, 1 bell pepper, half a zucchini, half a red onion, 1.5 tbsp olive oil, 0.75 cups white rice, 0.5 tsp dried oregano, 0.25 tsp smoked paprika, half a lemon, 0.5 cups plain Greek yogurt

Amounts above are scaled to your serving count. Where a step spells out a fixed amount (a teaspoon of salt, a cup of water), that means the full four-serving batch, so trim it to match.

STEPS

1. Start the rice following the package directions. Turn the broiler on high and move an oven rack about 6 inches below it. Line a baking sheet with foil.
2. Cut the chicken, peppers, zucchini, and onion into chunks of roughly the same size, about an inch. Wash the board, knife, and your hands with soap after the chicken.
3. Toss everything with the olive oil, the oregano, the smoked paprika, a teaspoon of salt, and some pepper, then thread onto skewers or just spread it on the pan.
4. Broil 6 to 7 minutes, turn everything with tongs, and broil 6 to 7 more, until the edges brown. Poke an instant-read thermometer into the middle of a big chicken chunk: 165 F means done.
5. Fluff the rice with a fork, squeeze the lemon over the chicken, and serve it all together with the yogurt for dipping.

MONDAY

Sesame Noodles with Chicken and Cucumber 25 min

YOU WILL NEED

6 oz spaghetti, 0.5 lb boneless chicken thighs, 1.5 tbsp low-sodium soy sauce, 1 tbsp toasted sesame oil, 0.5 tbsp honey, 0.5 tbsp rice vinegar, 0.25 tsp garlic powder, 1 cucumber, 0.5 bunches green onions, 0.5 tbsp vegetable oil

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STEPS

1. Fill your largest pot two-thirds with water, add a tablespoon of salt, cover, and bring it to a rolling boil over high heat.
2. Cut the chicken into bite-size pieces. Wash the board, knife, and your hands with soap right after.
3. Stir the soy sauce, sesame oil, honey, rice vinegar, and garlic powder together in a small bowl. Slice the cucumbers into thin half-moons and the green onions into rings.
4. Add the spaghetti to the boiling water and cook for the time on the box. Before draining, scoop out a coffee mug of the cooking water.
5. While the pasta cooks, heat the vegetable oil in a large skillet over medium-high. Add the chicken in one layer, leave it 4 minutes, then stir and cook 4 more. Poke an instant-read thermometer into a big piece: 165 F means done.
6. Turn off the heat. Add the drained spaghetti and the sauce to the skillet and toss, loosening with splashes of the saved water until the noodles are slick instead of sticky.
7. Pile the cucumbers and green onions on top. This one is good hot or at room temperature.

TUESDAY

Chicken Enchilada Skillet 30 min

YOU WILL NEED

0.75 lb boneless chicken thighs, 4 small corn tortillas, 0.5 cans (15 oz) enchilada sauce, 0.5 cans (15 oz) canned black beans, 0.5 cups frozen corn, half an onion, 0.5 tsp ground cumin, 0.5 tbsp olive oil, 0.5 cups shredded cheddar, half a lime

Amounts above are scaled to your serving count. Where a step spells out a fixed amount (a teaspoon of salt, a cup of water), that means the full four-serving batch, so trim it to match.

STEPS

1. Cut the chicken into bite-size pieces and chop the onion small. Wash the board, knife, and your hands with soap right after the chicken.
2. Warm the olive oil in your largest skillet over medium-high heat. Add the chicken and onion and cook 7 minutes, stirring twice.
3. Sprinkle in the cumin and stir 30 seconds. Poke an instant-read thermometer into the biggest piece of chicken: 165 F means done.
4. Open the beans, rinse them in a colander, and stir them in with the corn and the enchilada sauce. Let it bubble gently 3 minutes.
5. Stack the tortillas, cut them into strips about an inch wide, and fold them into the skillet so they soften in the sauce, about 3 minutes.
6. Turn off the heat and squeeze in half the lime. Sprinkle cheese over the side of the pan belonging to whoever wants it, and serve straight from the skillet.

WEDNESDAY

Baked Chicken Tenders and Sweet Potato Fries 35 min

YOU WILL NEED

0.75 lb chicken tenderloins, 1 sweet potato, 0.75 cups panko breadcrumbs, 0.5 tsp smoked paprika, 0.25 tsp garlic powder, 1 egg, 1.5 tbsp olive oil, 0.25 cups ketchup

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STEPS

1. Move an oven rack to the middle and heat the oven to 425 F. Get out two baking sheets.
2. Scrub the sweet potatoes (no peeling needed) and cut them into fries about as thick as your finger. Toss with 2 tablespoons of the olive oil and a big pinch of salt on one pan and spread them out flat.
3. Crack the eggs into a bowl and beat them with a fork. Pour the panko into a second bowl with the smoked paprika, the garlic powder, half a teaspoon of salt, and the last tablespoon of olive oil, and stir until the crumbs look slightly damp; this is what lets them turn golden.
4. One at a time: dip a tender in the egg, let the extra drip off, roll it in panko, press so the crumbs stick, and lay it on the second pan. Wash your hands when done.
5. Bake both pans 10 minutes, flip everything with tongs, then bake 10 more, until the tenders are golden. Poke an instant-read thermometer lengthwise into the thickest tender: it is done at 165 F.
6. Serve with ketchup.

THURSDAY

Creamy Tomato Pasta with Hidden Veggies 30 min

YOU WILL NEED

6 oz penne pasta, 0.5 jars (24 oz) marinara sauce, half a zucchini, 1 carrot, 1.5 oz cream cheese, 0.5 tsp Italian seasoning, 0.25 cups parmesan

Amounts above are scaled to your serving count. Where a step spells out a fixed amount (a teaspoon of salt, a cup of water), that means the full four-serving batch, so trim it to match.

STEPS

1. Fill your largest pot two-thirds with water, add a tablespoon of salt, cover, and bring it to a rolling boil over high heat.
2. While the water heats, peel the carrots and grate them and the zucchini on the large holes of a box grater. The zucchini skin can stay on.
3. Pour the marinara into a second pot over medium-low heat, stir in the grated vegetables and the Italian seasoning, and let it bubble gently for 8 minutes, stirring occasionally.
4. When the water boils, add the penne and cook for the time printed on the box. Before draining, scoop out a coffee mug of the cooking water, then drain the pasta in a colander.
5. Cut the cream cheese into chunks and stir it into the sauce until it melts smooth.
6. Mix the pasta into the sauce, adding splashes of the saved water if it looks too thick. Top with parmesan.

FRIDAY

Veggie Lo Mein 25 min

YOU WILL NEED

6 oz spaghetti, 0.5 bags (16 oz) frozen stir-fry vegetables, 2 tbsp low-sodium soy sauce, 0.5 tbsp toasted sesame oil, 0.5 tsp brown sugar, 0.25 tsp ground ginger, 0.25 tbsp cornstarch, 1.5 cloves garlic, 0.5 bunches green onions, 1 tbsp vegetable oil

Amounts above are scaled to your serving count. Where a step spells out a fixed amount (a teaspoon of salt, a cup of water), that means the full four-serving batch, so trim it to match.

STEPS

1. Fill your largest pot two-thirds with water, add a tablespoon of salt, cover, and bring it to a rolling boil. Cook the spaghetti for the time on the box, then drain it in a colander.
2. While the water heats, peel the garlic and chop it into tiny bits, and slice the green onions into thin rings.
3. Stir the soy sauce, sesame oil, brown sugar, ground ginger, cornstarch, and 3 tablespoons of water together in a small bowl until no lumps are left.
4. Heat the vegetable oil in your largest skillet over medium-high until it shimmers. Add the frozen vegetables straight from the bag and cook 5 minutes, stirring often, until they are hot and the water they release has cooked off.
5. Add the garlic and stir for 30 seconds.
6. Add the drained spaghetti, stir the sauce again, and pour it in. Toss for 2 minutes until the noodles are coated and no liquid pools in the bottom of the pan. Scatter the green onions over the top.

SATURDAY**Skillet Eggs in Spiced Tomato Sauce 30 min****YOU WILL NEED**

4 eggs, 0.5 cans (28 oz) canned crushed tomatoes, 1 bell pepper, half an onion, 1.5 cloves garlic, 0.5 tsp ground cumin, 0.5 tsp smoked paprika, 1 tbsp olive oil, 0.5 loaves whole grain bread

Amounts above are scaled to your serving count. Where a step spells out a fixed amount (a teaspoon of salt, a cup of water), that means the full four-serving batch, so trim it to match.

STEPS

1. Cut the peppers in half, pull out the stems, seeds, and white ribs, and slice them into thin strips. Peel and chop the onion small and chop the garlic into tiny bits.
2. Warm the olive oil in a large skillet over medium heat. Add the peppers and onion and cook 8 minutes, stirring now and then, until they are soft and floppy.
3. Add the garlic, cumin, and smoked paprika and stir 30 seconds until they smell toasty.
4. Pour in the crushed tomatoes with a teaspoon of salt. Let it bubble gently for 10 minutes, stirring often, until it thickens enough that dragging a spoon through leaves a trench for a second.
5. Make a shallow well in the sauce with the back of a spoon for each egg, and crack one into each.
6. Cover the pan, turn the heat to medium-low, and cook 7 to 10 minutes. The whites should be firm and no longer see-through; the yolks can be as runny or set as you like.
7. Toast the bread and serve it alongside for scooping.

Grocery list

PRODUCE

- 2 bell peppers
- 1 carrot
- 1 cucumber
- 1 bag (16 oz) frozen corn (need 0.5 cups)
- 1 bag (16 oz) frozen stir-fry vegetables (need 0.5 bags)
- 1 head of garlic (need 3 cloves)
- 1 bunch green onions
- 1 lemon (need half)
- 1 lime (need half)
- 1 onion
- 1 red onion (need half)
- 1 sweet potato
- 1 zucchini

MEAT AND PROTEIN

- 1.75 lb boneless chicken thighs
- 1 pack (1.5 lb) chicken tenderloins (need 0.75 lb)

DAIRY AND EGGS

- 1 brick (8 oz) cream cheese (need 1.5 oz)
- 1 dozen eggs (need 5)
- 1 container (8 oz) parmesan (need 0.25 cups)
- 1 tub (32 oz) plain Greek yogurt (need 0.5 cups)
- 1 bag (8 oz) shredded cheddar (need 0.5 cups)

BREAD, GRAINS, AND PASTA

- 1 box (16 oz) penne pasta (need 6 oz)
- 1 pack of 12 small corn tortillas (need 4)
- 1 box (16 oz) spaghetti (need 12 oz)
- 1 bag (2 lb) white rice (need 0.75 cups)
- 1 loaf whole grain bread (need 0.5 loaves)

PANTRY

- 1 can (15 oz) canned black beans (need 0.5 cans)
- 1 can (28 oz) canned crushed tomatoes (need 0.5 cans)
- 1 can (15 oz) enchilada sauce (need 0.5 cans)
- 1 jar (24 oz) marinara sauce (need 0.5 jars)
- 1 box (8 oz) panko breadcrumbs (need 0.75 cups)

FROM YOUR PANTRY

- 0.5 tsp brown sugar
- 0.25 tbsp cornstarch
- 0.5 tsp dried oregano
- 0.5 tsp garlic powder
- 1 tsp ground cumin
- 0.25 tsp ground ginger
- 0.5 tbsp honey
- 0.5 tsp Italian seasoning
- 0.25 cups ketchup
- 3.5 tbsp low-sodium soy sauce
- 4.5 tbsp olive oil
- 0.5 tbsp rice vinegar
- 1.25 tsp smoked paprika
- 1.5 tbsp toasted sesame oil
- 1.5 tbsp vegetable oil